

Peoples Bakers — Website Hosting Guide

Complete requirements, setup checklist & Mobitel inquiry template · June 2026

Important: This is not a simple static website. It requires a **Node.js server (v22.5+)** with backend API, SQLite database, and HTTPS. PHP-only shared hosting will **NOT** work.

1. What You Are Hosting

Item	Requirement
Runtime	Node.js 22.5 or higher
Start command	<code>npm start</code> → runs Express server
Database	SQLite file (peoples-bakers.db) — no MySQL server needed
Storage	Persistent disk (~1 GB) — orders must not be lost on restart
SSL/HTTPS	Required (login, PayHere payments, secure cookies)
RAM	Minimum 512 MB (1 GB recommended)

Website Features (Backend Required)

- Online ordering & checkout
- Customer login / registration / Google Sign-In
- Admin panel — orders, products, feedback, users
- PayHere online payment (Sri Lanka)
- Email order notifications (SMTP)
- Multi-language (English, Sinhala, Tamil)

2. Accounts You Need to Create

#	Account	Purpose
1	Domain registrar (Register.lk / LankaHost)	peoplesbakers.lk domain
2	Node.js hosting (Render / VPS / Mobitel Cloud)	Run the server 24/7
3	GitHub (optional)	Code upload & auto deploy
4	Gmail or business email	Order confirmation emails (SMTP)
5	PayHere (payhere.lk)	Online card payments
6	Google Cloud (optional)	Google login & Maps API

3. Hosting Options

Option	Suitable?	Notes
Render.com (Node.js)	✓ Best	Project includes render.yaml — Singapore region
VPS (DigitalOcean, Linode)	✓ Good	Full control — ~\$5–12/month
Mobitel VPS/Cloud (if Node.js supported)	Ask first	Confirm Node.js support before buying
PHP-only cPanel hosting	✗ No	Cannot run Node.js backend
GitHub Pages / Static Netlify	✗ No	No backend server

4. Environment Variables (.env)

Must Have (Production)

Variable	Example	Purpose
NODE_ENV	production	Production mode
JWT_SECRET	long random 32+ characters	Login security — change default!
SITE_URL	https://www.peoplesbakers.lk	Email links, PayHere URLs
DB_PATH	/var/data/peoples-bakers.db	Persistent database location

Recommended

Variable	Purpose
ADMIN_PATH	Secret admin URL (not linked on public site)
ADMIN_PROMOTE_EMAIL	Your email promoted to admin on server start
SMTP_HOST, SMTP_PORT, SMTP_USER, SMTP_PASS	Order confirmation emails
MAIL_FROM	Sender name for emails
WHATSAPP_NUMBER	94771234567 — chat button number

Optional

Variable	Purpose
GOOGLE_CLIENT_ID	Sign in with Google
GOOGLE_MAPS_API_KEY	Find Us — outlet auto-import
PAYHERE_MERCHANT_ID / PAYHERE_MERCHANT_SECRET	Online payments
PAYHERE_SANDBOX	true = test mode, false = live
PHONE_DISCOUNT_PERCENT / PHONE_DISCOUNT_MIN	Checkout phone discount (default 20%, min Rs.500)

5. PayHere Setup

1. Register at **payhere.lk** → get Merchant ID & Secret
2. Test first with sandbox: `sandbox.payhere.lk` (`PAYHERE_SANDBOX=true`)
3. Set Notify URL in PayHere dashboard:
`https://www.peoplesbakers.lk/api/payments/payhere/notify`
4. Must be public HTTPS — localhost will not work
5. Go live: `PAYHERE_SANDBOX=false` + live merchant keys

6. Gmail SMTP Setup

1. Enable 2-Step Verification on Google account
2. Create App Password: `myaccount.google.com/apppasswords`
3. Set `SMTP_HOST=smtp.gmail.com`, `SMTP_PORT=587`, `SMTP_USER`, `SMTP_PASS`
4. If SMTP is blank, site works but no emails are sent

7. Domain & DNS

Record	Name	Value
CNAME	www	Your hosting URL (e.g. peoples-bakers.onrender.com)
A or CNAME	@ (root)	Hosting IP or URL

Enable SSL on hosting dashboard. Update `SITE_URL` to your live HTTPS domain.

8. Admin Panel

Item	Details
Default URL	<code>https://yoursite.lk/pb-office.html</code>
Change URL	Set <code>ADMIN_PATH</code> in environment variables
First login (seed)	<code>admin@peoplesbakers.lk / admin123</code>
⚠ Must do before live	Change admin password immediately

9. Go-Live Checklist

- ☐ Code pushed to GitHub / uploaded to server
- ☐ Node.js hosting deployed with persistent disk
- ☐ `JWT_SECRET` set to strong random string
- ☐ `SITE_URL` set to live HTTPS URL
- ☐ Domain purchased and DNS configured

- ☐ SSL certificate active (HTTPS working)
- ☐ Admin password changed from default
- ☐ ADMIN_PATH changed to secret URL
- ☐ SMTP configured and test email sent
- ☐ PayHere sandbox payment tested
- ☐ All images uploaded (images/home/, products, outlets)
- ☐ Run: npm run verify — all checks pass

10. Estimated Costs

Item	Approximate Cost
.lk domain	Rs. 3,000 – 5,000 / year
Render paid + 1GB disk	\$7 – 15 / month
VPS alternative	\$5 – 12 / month
Gmail SMTP	Free
SSL certificate	Free (Let's Encrypt / Render)
PayHere	Merchant account setup via bank

11. Mobitel Inquiry — Email Template

Send this to Mobitel Business Support to confirm if they can host your application:

Subject: Inquiry – Website Hosting for Online Bakery (Node.js Application)

Dear Mobitel Business Support Team,

We are Peoples Bakers, a bakery business in Sri Lanka planning to launch our official website with online ordering, customer login, admin panel, and PayHere payment integration.

Our website requires a Node.js server (version 22+) – it is NOT a simple static HTML or PHP website. Data is stored in a SQLite database file and requires persistent storage.

Please confirm:

1. Does Mobitel provide Node.js hosting or VPS/Cloud suitable for this?
2. What packages are available and the cost?
3. Can you provide SSL and .lk domain support?
4. Is persistent disk storage included?
5. What documents/details do you need from us?

Technical requirements:

- Node.js 22.5+
- 512MB–1GB RAM
- 1GB persistent storage
- HTTPS/SSL certificate
- Custom domain support
- 24/7 server uptime

Thank you.

[Your Name] – Peoples Bakers

Phone: [07X XXX XXXX]

Email: [your@email.com]

12. Mobitel WhatsApp / Phone Script (Sinhala)

Ayubowan, mam Peoples Bakers bakery business eken online website ekak live karanna hadanawa.

Me site eka Node.js server ekak run wenna one – online orders, login, admin panel, PayHere payment. PHP-only hosting valin backend eka run wenne ne.

Confirm karanna puluwanda:

1. Mobitel eken Node.js / VPS / cloud server support thiyenawada?
2. HTTPS, domain (.lk), 24/7 uptime thiyenawada?
3. Orders save wenna persistent storage thiyenawada?
4. Monthly cost monawada?
5. Apita denna one documents monawada?

Technical: Node.js 22+, 1GB storage, SSL, custom domain.

Thank you. [Name] [Phone]

13. Key Questions to Ask Any Host

Question	Why
Does it support Node.js 22+?	PHP-only hosts will not work
Is disk storage persistent?	Orders must not delete on restart
Is SSL/HTTPS included?	Required for PayHere & login
Can PayHere webhook URL receive HTTPS callbacks?	Payment notifications
Monthly cost & setup fee?	Budget planning
Do you help with setup?	Technical assistance availability

14. If Mobitel Cannot Support Node.js

Use **Render.com** (Node.js hosting) + buy **.lk domain** separately from Register.lk or LankaHost. Point DNS to Render. This is the recommended alternative and the project already includes a Render deployment configuration (render.yaml).

15. Useful Commands (Developer)

Command	Purpose
npm install	Install dependencies
npm start	Start server (port 3000)
npm run verify	Check all backend endpoints
npm run promote-admin -- email@example.com	Make user an admin